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ME 3313

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## ME 3313 Honors Project

### Introduction

For this project, I am analyzing the linkages of a skid-steer bucket loader, shown in Figure 1. I will explore each of the topics we explore in ME 3313, starting with mobility, and going on to topics including range of motion, position, velocity, acceleration, and forces, and use each of these topics to analyze the linkage. I will then explore synthesis and try to create my own linkage for the bucket loader.



Figure 1: Side view of a Skid

### Mobility

Mobility is a measure of how many degrees of freedom a linkage has, and it is calculated with Equation (1), called the Grubler-Kutzbach Mobility equation, where  $M$  is the mobility,  $L$  is the number of links,  $J_1$  is the number of full joints, and  $J_2$  is the number of half joints.

$$M = 3(L - 1) - 2J_1 - J_2 \quad (1)$$

A link is a single rigid body. A full joint is a joint with 1 degree of freedom, like a pin or two flat surfaces sliding along each other. A half joint is a joint with 2 degrees of freedom, like a pin in a joint, or two curved surface rolling or slipping along each other. On a kinematic diagram of a linkage, each link is marked with a unique plain number from 1 to the number of links, each full joint is marked with a unique circled number from 1 to the number of full joints, and each half joint is marked with a unique boxed number from 1 to the

number of half joints. As shown in Figure 2, the main linkage of the skid-steer has 6 links, 7 full joints, and 0 half joints. Using the mobility equation as shown in Equation (2), the mobility is calculated to be 1.

$$M = 3(L - 1) - 2J_1 - J_2 = 3(6 - 1) - 2 * 7 - 0 = 1 \quad (2)$$

Because the mobility is 1, only one input is needed to control the linkage. In this case, the input is a hydraulic piston, which is a combination of links 4 and 6. Figure 3 shows the annotated linkage diagram overlain on the original image of the skid-steer.

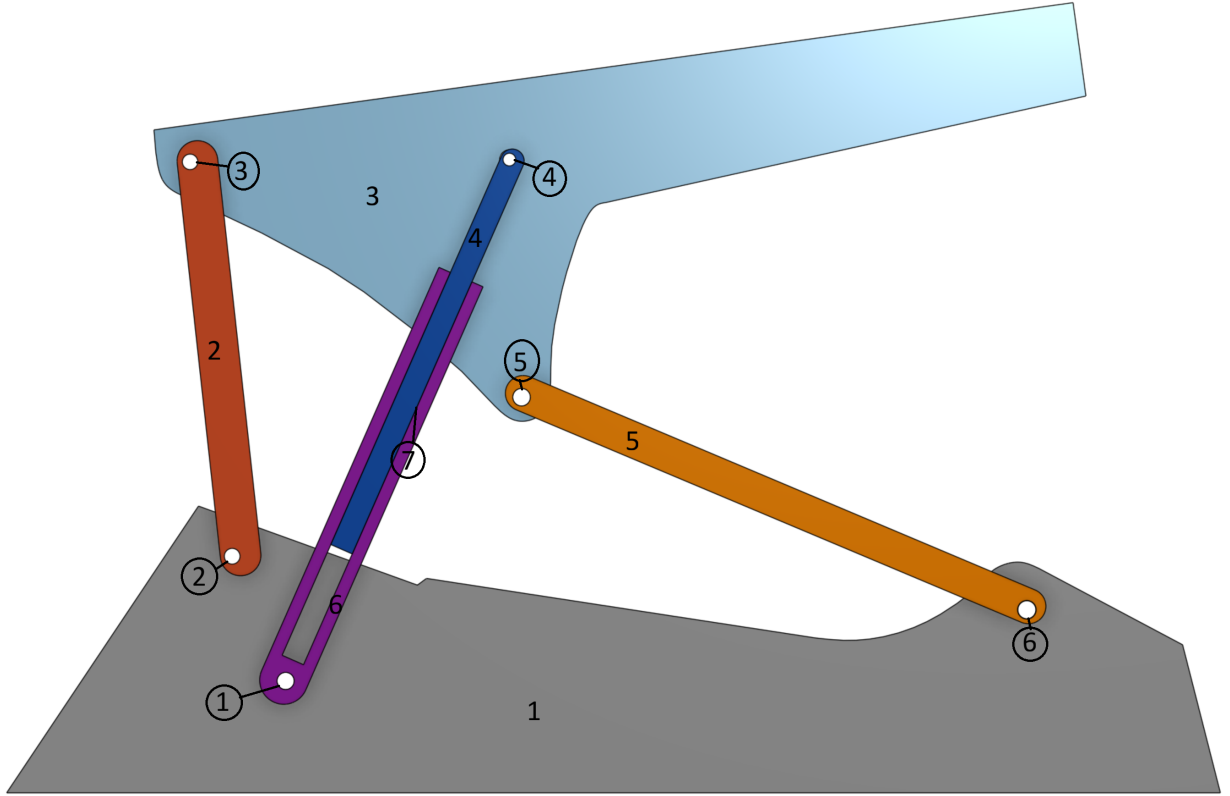


Figure 2: Annotated Linkage



Figure 3: Annotated Linkage Overlain On Skid-Steer

## Multiloop Closure Equations

Mobility allows us to determine the degrees of freedom of a linkage, but usually we also need to determine the positions and angles of the individual links. To do this, we can use a method called Multiloop closure. It consists of drawing vectors between joints of each link, then writing equation summing loops of vectors, because the RHS of the equation has to equal zero. This is because the last vector ends where the first vector starts. These vector equations can then be turned into their scalar forms, which can be combined with equations relating rigid geometry of the links, providing a system of equations to solve. When done correctly, the number of unknowns minus the number of scalar and rigid geometry equations should equal the mobility. For the examined linkage, the vectors and loops are labeled as shown in Figure 4. The vector equations are shown below as eqs. (3) and (4).

$$\vec{R}_{BA} + \vec{R}_{DB} - \vec{R}_{CA} - \vec{R}_{GC} - \vec{R}_{DG} = 0 \quad (3)$$

$$\vec{R}_{GC} + \vec{R}_{DG} - \vec{R}_{DE} - \vec{R}_{EF} - \vec{R}_{FC} = 0 \quad (4)$$

These equations can be expanded into their scalar forms as shown in eqs. (5) to (10) below, where each  $\theta$  is measured counter-clockwise from the horizontal to the tail of the corresponding vector.

$$R_{BA} \cos \theta_{BA} + R_{DB} \cos \theta_{DB} - R_{CA} \cos \theta_{CA} - R_{GC} \cos \theta_{GC} - R_{DG} \cos \theta_{DG} = 0 \quad (5)$$

$$R_{BA} \sin \theta_{BA} + R_{DB} \sin \theta_{DB} - R_{CA} \sin \theta_{CA} - R_{GC} \sin \theta_{GC} - R_{DG} \sin \theta_{DG} = 0 \quad (6)$$

$$R_{GC} \cos \theta_{GC} + R_{DG} \cos \theta_{DG} - R_{DE} \cos \theta_{DE} - R_{EF} \cos \theta_{EF} - R_{FC} \cos \theta_{FC} = 0 \quad (7)$$



$$R_{GC} \sin \theta_{GC} + R_{DG} \sin \theta_{DG} - R_{DE} \sin \theta_{DE} - R_{EF} \sin \theta_{EF} - R_{FC} \sin \theta_{FC} = 0 \quad (8)$$

$$\theta_{GC} - \theta_{DG} = 0 \quad (9)$$

$$\theta_{DB} + \beta_D - \theta_{DE} = 0 \quad (10)$$

In these equations,  $R_{BA}$ ,  $R_{DB}$ ,  $R_{CA}$ ,  $\theta_{CA}$ ,  $R_{GC}$ ,  $R_{DE}$ ,  $R_{EF}$ ,  $R_{FC}$ ,  $\theta_{FC}$ , and  $\beta_D$  are known from the geometry of the linkage and do not change. This leaves  $\theta_{BA}$ ,  $\theta_{DB}$ ,  $\theta_{GC}$ ,  $R_{DG}$ ,  $\theta_{DG}$ ,  $\theta_{DE}$ , and  $\theta_{EF}$  as unknowns for a total of 7 unknowns. Taking 7 unknowns minus 6 equations yields 1 degree of freedom, which agrees with the earlier mobility analysis. Also,  $R_{DG}$  will be the input because it is controlled by a hydraulic piston.

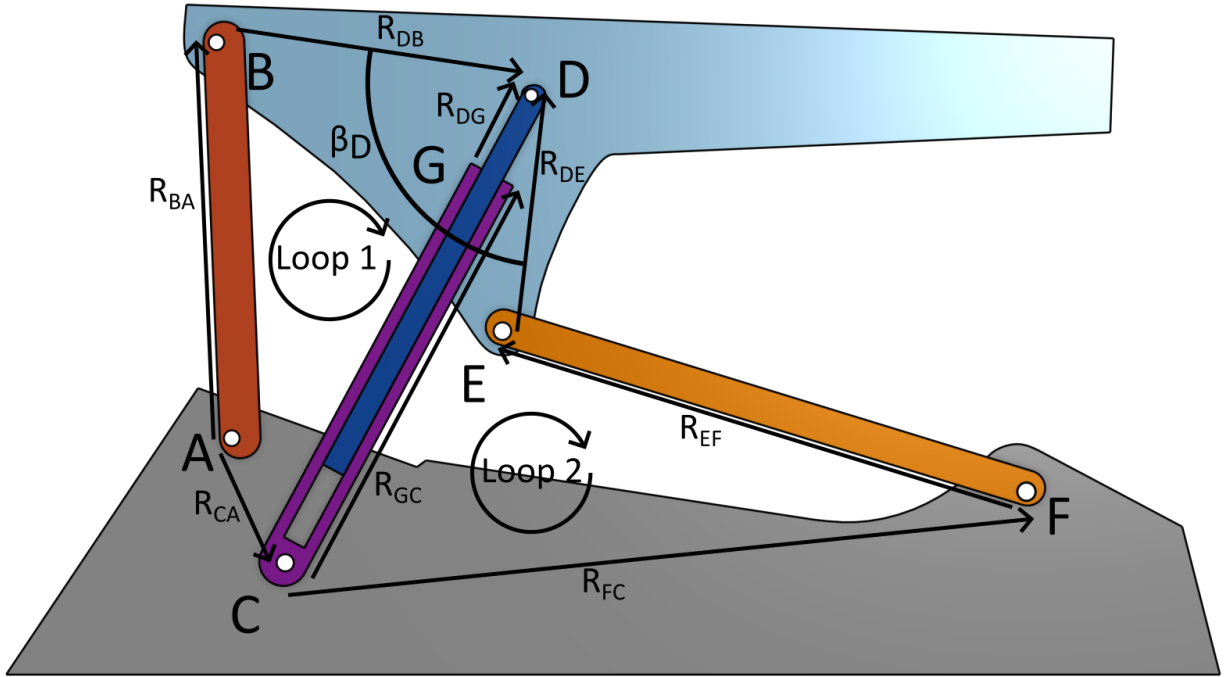


Figure 4: Diagram showing vector for Multiloop Equations

## Loop Equation Derivatives

The next step in analyzing the linkage is to take the first and second derivatives of the scalar loop equations, which we can then use to find equations for velocity and acceleration of the links. The first derivatives of eqs. (5) to (10) are as shown below as eqs. (11) to (16), respectively.

$$-R_{BA}\omega_{BA} \sin \theta_{BA} - R_{DB}\omega_{DB} \sin \theta_{DB} + R_{GC}\omega_{GC} \sin \theta_{GC} - \dot{R}_{DG} \cos \theta_{DG} + R_{DG}\omega_{DG} \sin \theta_{DG} = 0 \quad (11)$$

$$R_{BA}\omega_{BA} \cos \theta_{BA} + R_{DB}\omega_{DB} \cos \theta_{DB} - R_{GC}\omega_{GC} \cos \theta_{GC} - \dot{R}_{DG} \sin \theta_{DG} - R_{DG}\omega_{DG} \cos \theta_{DG} = 0 \quad (12)$$



$$-R_{GC}\omega_{GC}\sin\theta_{GC} + \dot{R}_{DG}\cos\theta_{DG} - R_{DG}\omega_{DG}\sin\theta_{DG} + R_{DE}\omega_{DE}\sin\theta_{DE} + R_{EF}\omega_{EF}\sin\theta_{EF} = 0 \quad (13)$$

$$R_{GC}\omega_{GC}\cos\theta_{GC} + \dot{R}_{DG}\sin\theta_{DG} + R_{DG}\omega_{DG}\cos\theta_{DG} - R_{DE}\omega_{DE}\cos\theta_{DE} - R_{EF}\omega_{EF}\cos\theta_{EF} = 0 \quad (14)$$

$$\omega_{GC} - \omega_{DG} = 0 \quad (15)$$

$$\omega_{DB} - \omega_{DE} = 0 \quad (16)$$

The second derivatives of eqs. (5) to (10) are shown below as eqs. (17) to (22), respectively.

$$\begin{aligned} & -R_{BA}\alpha_{BA}\sin\theta_{BA} - R_{BA}\omega_{BA}^2\cos\theta_{BA} - R_{DB}\alpha_{DB}\sin\theta_{DB} \\ & - R_{DB}\omega_{DB}^2\cos\theta_{DB} + R_{GC}\alpha_{GC}\sin\theta_{GC} + R_{GC}\omega_{GC}^2\cos\theta_{GC} - \ddot{R}_{DG}\cos\theta_{DG} \\ & + 2\dot{R}_{DG}\omega_{DG}\sin\theta_{DG} + R_{DG}\alpha_{DG}\sin\theta_{DG} + R_{DG}\omega_{DG}^2\cos\theta_{DG} = 0 \end{aligned} \quad (17)$$

$$\begin{aligned} & R_{BA}\alpha_{BA}\cos\theta_{BA} - R_{BA}\omega_{BA}^2\sin\theta_{BA} + R_{DB}\alpha_{DB}\cos\theta_{DB} - R_{DB}\omega_{DB}^2\sin\theta_{DB} \\ & - R_{GC}\alpha_{GC}\cos\theta_{GC} + R_{GC}\omega_{GC}^2\sin\theta_{GC} - \ddot{R}_{DG}\sin\theta_{DG} \\ & - 2\dot{R}_{DG}\omega_{DG}\cos\theta_{DG} - R_{DG}\alpha_{DG}\cos\theta_{DG} + R_{DG}\omega_{DG}^2\sin\theta_{DG} = 0 \end{aligned} \quad (18)$$

$$\begin{aligned} & -R_{GC}\alpha_{GC}\sin\theta_{GC} - R_{GC}\omega_{GC}^2\cos\theta_{GC} + \ddot{R}_{DG}\cos\theta_{DG} - 2\dot{R}_{DG}\omega_{DG}\sin\theta_{DG} \\ & - R_{DG}\alpha_{DG}\sin\theta_{DG} - R_{DG}\omega_{DG}^2\cos\theta_{DG} + R_{DE}\alpha_{DE}\sin\theta_{DE} \\ & + R_{DE}\omega_{DE}^2\cos\theta_{DE} + R_{EF}\alpha_{EF}\sin\theta_{EF} + R_{EF}\omega_{EF}^2\cos\theta_{EF} = 0 \end{aligned} \quad (19)$$

$$\begin{aligned} & R_{GC}\alpha_{GC}\cos\theta_{GC} - R_{GC}\omega_{GC}^2\sin\theta_{GC} + \ddot{R}_{DG}\sin\theta_{DG} + 2\dot{R}_{DG}\omega_{DG}\cos\theta_{DG} \\ & + R_{DG}\alpha_{DG}\cos\theta_{DG} - R_{DG}\omega_{DG}^2\sin\theta_{DG} - R_{DE}\alpha_{DE}\cos\theta_{DE} \\ & + R_{DE}\omega_{DE}^2\sin\theta_{DE} - R_{EF}\alpha_{EF}\cos\theta_{EF} + R_{EF}\omega_{EF}^2\sin\theta_{EF} = 0 \end{aligned} \quad (20)$$

$$\alpha_{GC} - \alpha_{DG} = 0 \quad (21)$$

$$\alpha_{DB} - \alpha_{DE} = 0 \quad (22)$$

## Code Introduction

To solve these equations, I used Python code taking advantage of the `fsolve` function from the SciPy library. This is a numerical solver function that takes in a set of equations and initial guesses and outputs a solution. Depending on the initial guess, this solution can be incorrect, or a valid solution but not the correct solution for the actual problem constraints. To increase the chances significantly of a valid solution being generated, I generated a range of initial condition options for each unknown variable and then generated a solution for every combination of initial conditions. Taking these, I kept only ones that had little error when plugged back into the multiloop equations and each variable was within an estimated range of motion. The known link lengths that were plugged into the equations are shown below, and the input length is shown under that. These measurements are only estimates, however, because I found them by finding the length of the loader in its documentation, then measured the length in a side view image of the loader. I took the ratio of these, then measured each link length and angle in the picture and multiplied each link length by the ratio to get the estimated actual link length. Angles however are not affected by scaling an image up or down though, so I used the measured angles as they were.

I then took this solution and used it to find solutions along a range of input angles. Because angles that are close together will have similar solutions, I was able to start at my calculated solution and use it as the initial guess for a slightly different angle. This would quickly converge to another solution close by, yielding a correct solution. Using this new solution as my next guess, I was able to repeat this and get the solution for a range of input angles. I then wrote equations for the absolute position of each joint in the linkage, with the origin at Joint C. The vector forms of these equations are shown below in eqs. (23) to (30). Using these equations and the range of solutions I found previously I plotted the path each joint followed for that range of angles, shown in Figure 5.

$$\vec{A} = -R_{CA} \quad (23)$$

$$\vec{B} = -R_{CA} + R_{BA} \quad (24)$$

$$\vec{C} = 0 \quad (25)$$

$$\vec{D} = R_{FC} + R_{EF} + R_{DE} \quad (26)$$

$$\vec{E} = R_{FC} + R_{EF} \quad (27)$$

$$\vec{F} = R_{FC} \quad (28)$$

$$\vec{G} = R_{GC} \quad (29)$$

$$\vec{P} = -R_{CA} + R_{BA} + R_{PB} \quad (30)$$

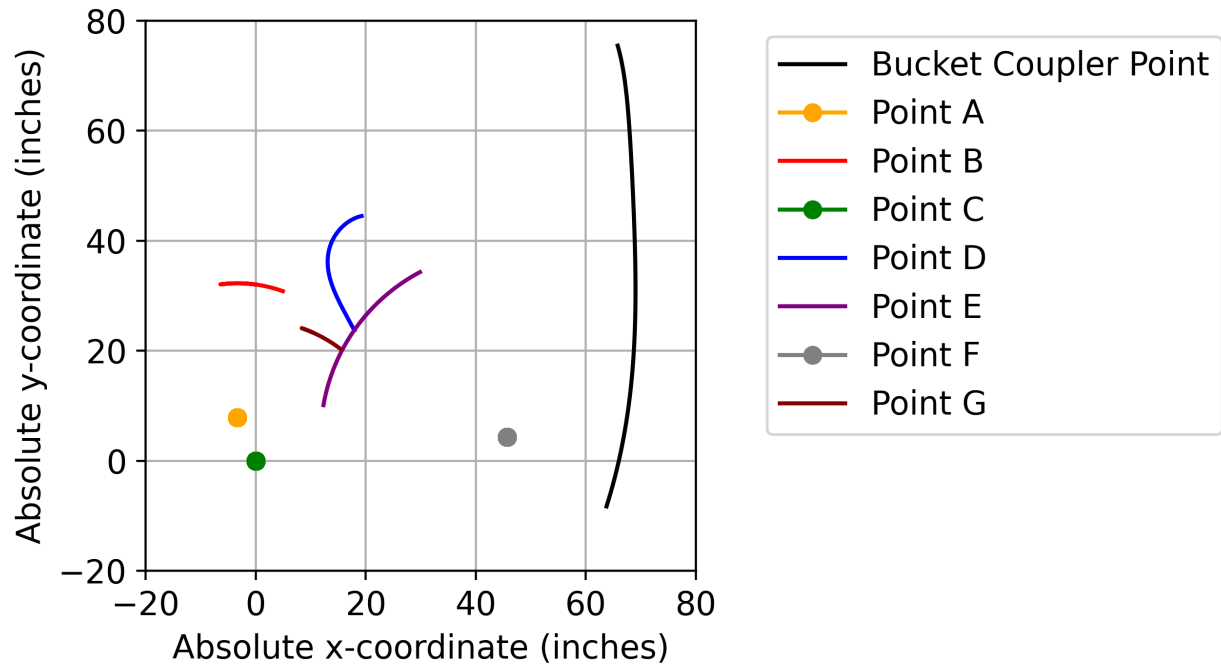


Figure 5: Path of absolute position of linkage joints

Next, I took the list of angles for each input length and used these angles and the previously measured link lengths in eqs. (11) to (22) to solve for angular velocity and angular acceleration of each point. The angular velocity and acceleration of Link BA is plotted in Figure 6 and Figure 7.



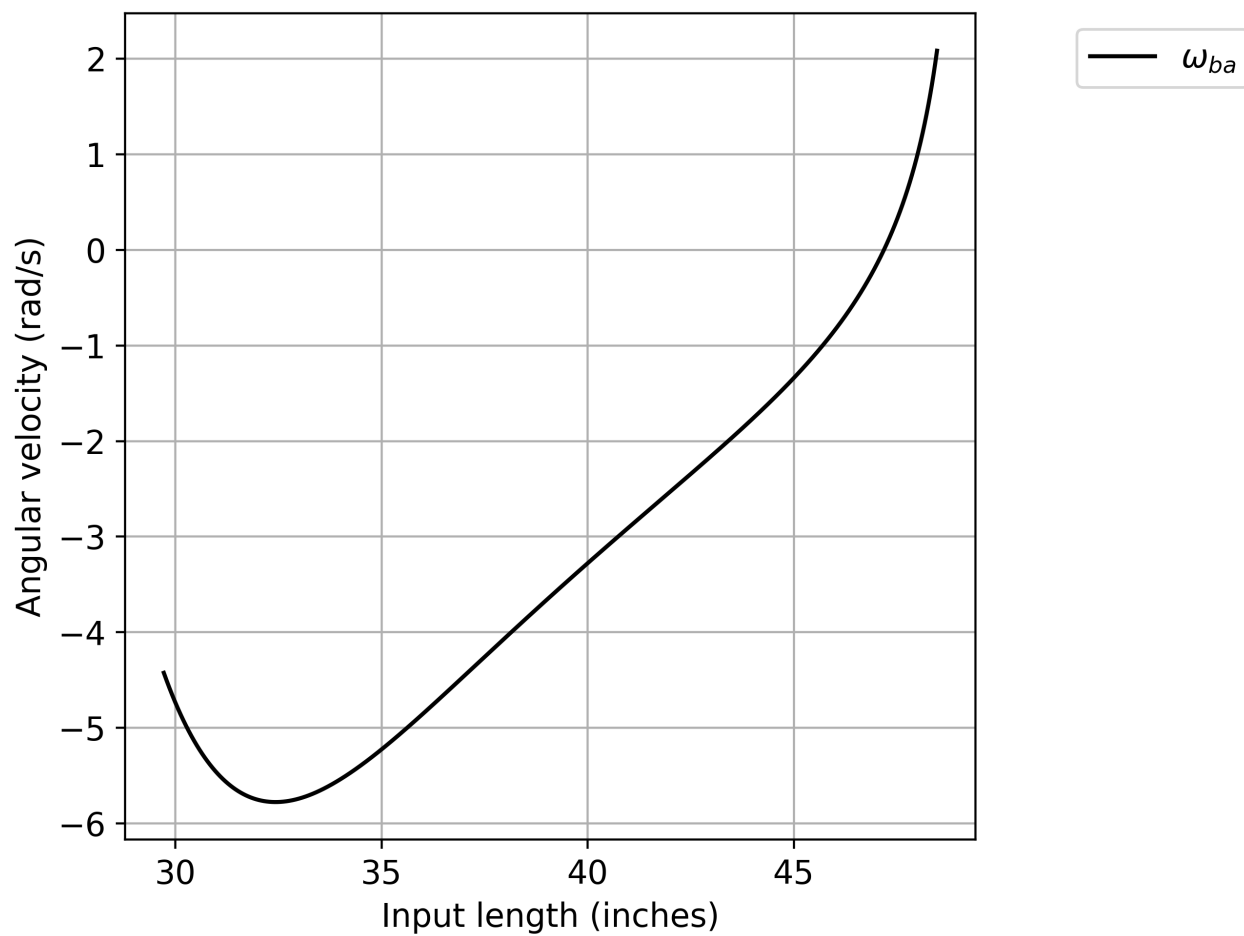


Figure 6: Angular velocity of Link BA vs the input length

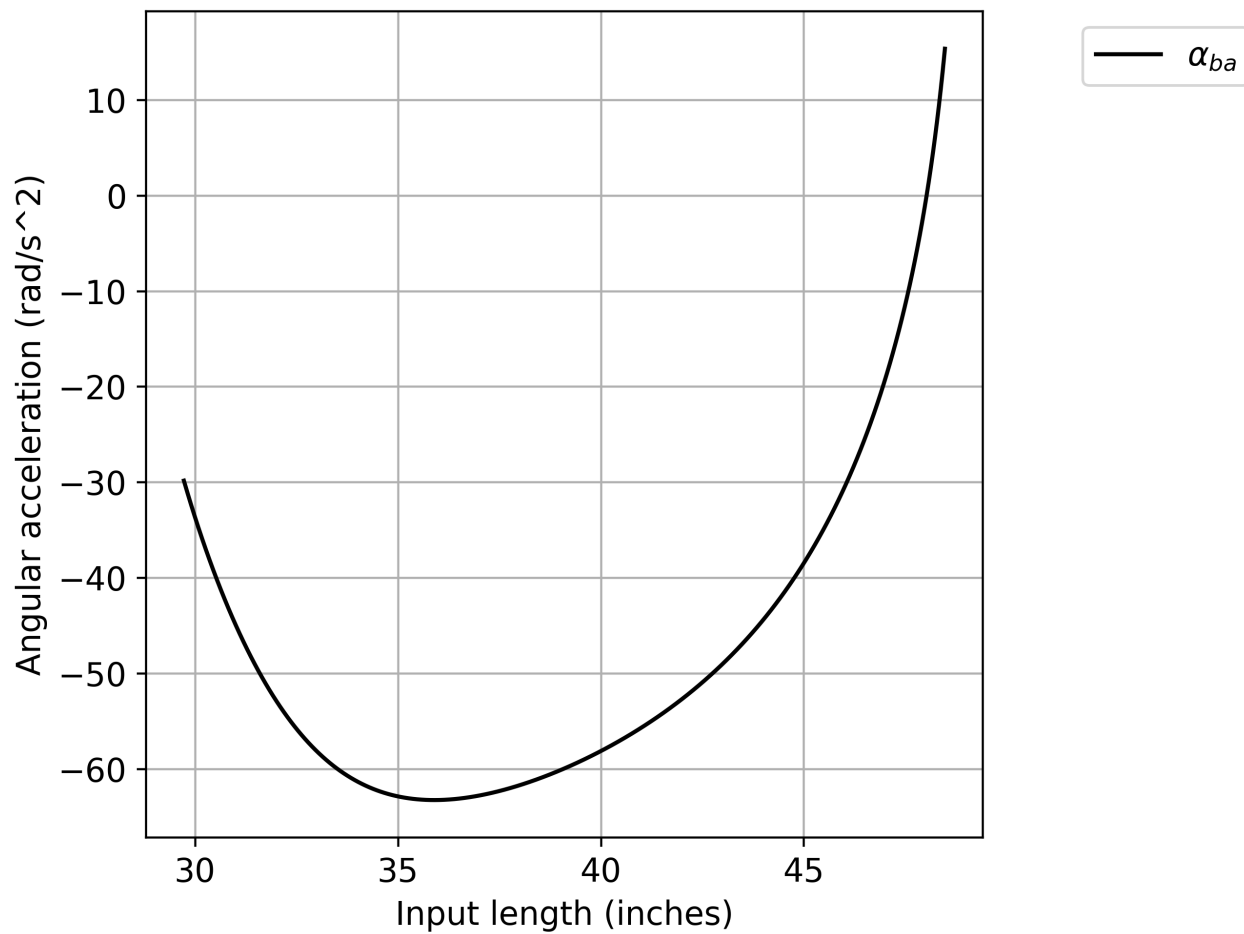


Figure 7: Angular acceleration of Link BA vs the input length

## Link Measurements

$$R_{BA} = 24.4 \text{ in.}$$

$$R_{DB} = 19.8 \text{ in.}$$

$$R_{CA} = 8.5 \text{ in.}$$

$$\theta_{CA} = 293.04^\circ$$

$$R_{GC} = 25.5 \text{ in.}$$

$$R_{DE} = 14.7 \text{ in.}$$

$$R_{EF} = 33.9 \text{ in.}$$

$$R_{FC} = 45.9 \text{ in.}$$

$$\theta_{FC} = 5.44^\circ$$

$$\beta_D = 92.47^\circ$$

## Input Link Length

$$R_{DC} = 29.72 \text{ in.}$$

## Multiloop Solver Code

---

```
1 import os
2 import numpy as np
3 import math
4 from scipy.optimize import fsolve
5 import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
6 from warnings import catch_warnings
7
8 act_img_ratio = 0.1718 # Approximate ratio of length without bucket from specs
9   ↳ in inches over length without bucket from image in mm
10
11 #act_img_ratio = 1      # Uncomment to use image link lengths instead of
12   ↳ approximated actual lengths
13 # Known values (For the moment just measured in millimeters from image
14   ↳ multiplied by ratio)
15 rba = 142.27*act_img_ratio
16 rdb = 115.2*act_img_ratio
17 rca = 49.46*act_img_ratio
18 thetaca = math.radians(293.04)
19 rgc = 148.5*act_img_ratio # Can't really tell from picture, but should not
20   ↳ affect results as long as counted for accordingly
21 rde = 85.65*act_img_ratio
22 ref = 197.12*act_img_ratio
23 rfc = 267.12*act_img_ratio
24 thetafc = math.radians(5.44) # angle from positive x-axis to ground link, which
25   ↳ is Rea
26 betad = math.radians(92.47) # Angle from DB to DA
27 rpb = 439.41*act_img_ratio # distance from point b to the bucket coupler point
```

```

23 betab = math.radians(7.41) # Angle from rpb to rdb
24
25
26 # Inputs
27 rdc = 173*act_img_ratio
28 rdotdg = 100 # rate of change of length of hydraulic piston
29 rddotdg = 0 # rate of change of rate of change of length of hydraulic piston
30
31 rdg = rdc - rgc # Given input length
32
33 # Finds most common element in a list
34 def most_common(lst: list):
35     return max(set(lst), key=lst.count)
36
37
38 """
39 Unknowns:
40 x[0]: thetaba
41 x[1]: thetadb
42 x[2]: thetagc
43 x[3]: thetadg
44 x[4]: thetade
45 x[5]: thetaef
46 """
47 unknown_length_indices = []
48 used_inputs = []
49 num_equations = 6
50
51 # System of scalar equations to solve
52 def angle_eqs(x):
53     return [
54         rba*np.cos(x[0]) + rdb*np.cos(x[1]) - rca*np.cos(thetaca) -
55         ↪ rgc*np.cos(x[2]) - rdg*np.cos(x[3]),
56         rba*np.sin(x[0]) + rdb*np.sin(x[1]) - rca*np.sin(thetaca) -
57         ↪ rgc*np.sin(x[2]) - rdg*np.sin(x[3]),
58         rgc*np.cos(x[2]) + rdg*np.cos(x[3]) - rde*np.cos(x[4]) -
59         ↪ ref*np.cos(x[5]) - rfc*np.cos(thetaefc),
60         rgc*np.sin(x[2]) + rdg*np.sin(x[3]) - rde*np.sin(x[4]) -
61         ↪ ref*np.sin(x[5]) - rfc*np.sin(thetaefc),
62         x[2]-x[3],
63         x[1]+betad-x[4]
64     ]
65
66 def angular_velocity_eqs(thetaba, thetadb, thetagc, rdotdg, thetadg, thetade,
67 ↪ thetaef, rdc):
68     rdg = rdc - rgc
69     return [
70         [-rba*np.sin(thetaba), -rdb*np.sin(thetadb), rgc*np.sin(thetagc),
71         ↪ rdg*np.sin(thetadg), 0, 0],
72         [rba*np.cos(thetaba), rdb*np.cos(thetadb), -rgc*np.cos(thetagc),
73         ↪ -rdg*np.cos(thetadg), 0, 0],
74         [0, 0, -rgc*np.sin(thetagc), -rdg*np.sin(thetadg), rde*np.sin(thetade),
75         ↪ ref*np.sin(thetaef)],
76         [0, 0, rgc*np.cos(thetagc), rdg*np.cos(thetadg), -rde*np.cos(thetade),
77         ↪ -ref*np.cos(thetaef)],

```

```

69     [0, 0, 1, -1, 0, 0],
70     [0, 1, 0, 0, -1, 0]
71 ], [
72     rdotdg*np.cos(thetadg),
73     -rdotdg*np.sin(thetadg),
74     -rdotdg*np.cos(thetadg),
75     -rdotdg*np.sin(thetadg),
76     0,
77     0
78 ]
79
80 def angular_acceleration_eqs(thetaba, thetadb, thetagc, rdotdg, thetadg,
    ↪ thetade, thetaef, rdc, rddotdg, omegaba, omegadb, omegagc, omegadg, omegade,
    ↪ omegaef):
81     rdg = rdc - rgc
82     return [
83         [-rba*np.sin(thetaba), -rdb*np.sin(thetadb), rgc*np.sin(thetagc),
    ↪ rdg*np.sin(thetadg), 0, 0],
84         [rba*np.cos(thetaba), -rdb*np.cos(thetadb), -rgc*np.cos(thetagc),
    ↪ -rdg*np.cos(thetadg), 0, 0],
85         [0, 0, -rgc*np.sin(thetagc), -rdg*np.sin(thetadg), rde*np.sin(thetade),
    ↪ ref*np.sin(thetaef)],
86         [0, 0, rgc*np.cos(thetagc), rdg*np.cos(thetadg), -rde*np.cos(thetade),
    ↪ -ref*np.cos(thetaef)],
87         [0, 0, 1, -1, 0, 0],
88         [0, 1, 0, 0, -1, 0]
89     ], [
90         rba*(omegaba**2)*np.cos(thetaba) + rdb*(omegadb**2)*np.cos(thetadb) -
    ↪ rgc*(omegagc**2)*np.cos(thetagc) + rddotdg*np.cos(thetadg) -
    ↪ 2*rdotdg*omegadg*np.sin(thetadg) - rdg*(omegadg**2)*np.cos(thetadg),
91         rba*(omegaba**2)*np.sin(thetaba) + rdb*(omegadb**2)*np.sin(thetadb) -
    ↪ rgc*(omegagc**2)*np.sin(thetagc) + rddotdg*np.sin(thetadg) +
    ↪ 2*rdotdg*omegadg*np.cos(thetadg) - rdg*(omegadg**2)*np.sin(thetadg),
92         rgc*(omegagc**2)*np.cos(thetagc) - rddotdg*np.cos(thetadg) +
    ↪ 2*rdotdg*omegadg*np.sin(thetadg) + rdg*(omegadg**2)*np.cos(thetadg)
    ↪ - rde*(omegade**2)*np.cos(thetade) -
    ↪ ref*(omegaef**2)*np.cos(thetaef),
93         rgc*(omegagc**2)*np.sin(thetagc) - rddotdg*np.sin(thetadg) -
    ↪ 2*rdotdg*omegadg*np.cos(thetadg) + rdg*(omegadg**2)*np.sin(thetadg)
    ↪ - rde*(omegade**2)*np.sin(thetade) -
    ↪ ref*(omegaef**2)*np.sin(thetaef),
94         0,
95         0
96     ]
97
98 # Rename pi for shorter call
99 pi = math.pi
100
101 # For finding right guesses
102 initial_guess_min = [0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0]
103 initial_guess_max = [2*pi, 2*pi, 2*pi, 2*pi, 2*pi, 2*pi]
104 current_guess = [0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0]
105
106 # Create empty set to store unique solutions
107 gen_solutions = set()

```



```

108
109 # Check if solution is in approximate range of motion
110 def result_check(result) -> bool:
111     if result[0] > 3*pi/4 or result[0] < pi/4:
112
113         return False
114     if result[1] > pi/2 and result[1] < 3*pi/2:
115
116         return False
117     if result[2] > pi/2:
118
119         return False
120     if result[3] > pi/2:
121
122         return False
123     if result[4] > pi:
124
125         return False
126     if result[5] < pi/2 or result[5] > pi:
127
128         return False
129     return True
130
131 # Check error of solution
132 """def calc_err(result, eq=eqs):
133     err = eq(result)
134     err_sum = 0
135     for i in range(len(err)):
136         err_sum += float(np.abs(err[i]))
137     return err_sum"""
138
139 def calc_err(result, eq=angle_eqs, unkn_len_ind=unknown_length_indices):
140     err = eq(result)
141     err_sum = 0
142     for i in range(len(err)):
143         if i in unkn_len_ind:
144             calc_err_amt = float(np.abs(err[i]))
145         else:
146             calc_err_amt = float(np.abs(err[i])) % 2*pi
147             calc_err_amt = min(calc_err_amt, 2*pi - calc_err_amt)
148         err_sum += calc_err_amt
149     return err_sum
150
151
152 # Populate the solution set with valid solutions
153 def solution_gen(current_guess: list[float] | None = None, guess_per_var: int =
    ↪ 5, index: int = 0, initial_min: list[float] = initial_guess_min,
    ↪ initial_max: list[float] = initial_guess_max, output: set[tuple[float, ...]]
    ↪ = gen_solutions, eq=angle_eqs, num_var: int = num_equations,
    ↪ unkn_len_ind=unknown_length_indices):
154     if current_guess is None:
155         current_guess = []
156     if len(initial_min) != num_var and len(initial_max) != num_var:
157         exit("Initial and/or final guess are wrong length")
158

```

```

159     if index == num_var:
160         with catch_warnings(record=True) as recorded_warnings:
161             sol = fsolve(eq, current_guess)
162             curr_error = calc_err(sol, eq)
163             if result_check(sol) and curr_error < 0.1:
164                 output.add(tuple(sol))
165         return
166
167     guesses = np.linspace(initial_min[index], initial_max[index], guess_per_var)
168
169     # Finds solutions with all different combinations of guesses
170     for guess in guesses:
171         solution_gen(current_guess=current_guess+[guess],
172                     ↪ guess_per_var=guess_per_var, index=index+1, initial_min=initial_min,
173                     ↪ initial_max=initial_max, output=output, eq=eq, num_var=num_var,
174                     ↪ unkn_len_ind=unkn_len_ind)
175     return
176
177 # Absolute position of bucket coupler point with point C as the origin, positive
178 ↪ x-axis to the right
179 def link_point_pos(angles):
180     point_c = (0, 0)
181     point_a = (-rca*math.cos(thetaca), -rca*math.sin(thetaca))
182     point_f = (rfc*math.cos(thetafc), rfc*math.sin(thetafc))
183     point_b = (point_a[0] + rba*math.cos(angles[0]), point_a[1] +
184             ↪ rba*math.sin(angles[0]))
185     point_e = (point_f[0] + ref*math.cos(angles[5]), point_f[1] +
186             ↪ ref*math.sin(angles[5]))
187     point_g = (rgc*math.cos(angles[2]), rgc*math.sin(angles[2]))
188     point_d = (point_e[0] + rde*math.cos(angles[4]), point_e[1] +
189             ↪ rde*math.sin(angles[4]))
190     bucket = (point_b[0] + rpb*math.cos(angles[1]-betab), point_b[1] +
191             ↪ rpb*math.sin(angles[1]-betab))
192     return point_a, point_b, point_c, point_d, point_e, point_f, point_g, bucket
193
194 # Generate solutions
195 solution_gen()
196
197 used_inputs.append(rdc)
198
199 # Turn set into a list so it is indexable
200 gen_solutions = list(gen_solutions)

```

```

206
207 min_error = 1
208 min_sol = None
209 for sol in gen_solutions:
210     err = calc_err(sol)
211     if err < min_error:
212         min_error = err
213         min_sol = sol
214
215
216 s = min_sol
217
218 if s is None:
219     exit("No solutions found")
220
221 sol_domain = np.linspace(rdc, 1.9*rgc, 10000)
222 rdc_store = rdc
223 sol_set = [s]
224 for x in sol_domain[1:]:
225     rdc = x
226     rdg = rdc - rgc
227     with catch_warnings(record=True) as record_warnings:
228         try:
229             new_sol = fsolve(angle_eqs, sol_set[-1])
230             sol_set.append(new_sol)
231             used_inputs.append(rdc)
232         except:
233             continue
234
235
236
237
238
239 rdc = rdc_store
240 rdg = rdc - rgc
241
242 point_ax = []
243 point_ay = []
244 point_bx = []
245 point_by = []
246 point_cx = []
247 point_cy = []
248 point_dx = []
249 point_dy = []
250 point_ex = []
251 point_ey = []
252 point_fx = []
253 point_fy = []
254 point_gx = []
255 point_gy = []
256 bucket_x = []
257 bucket_y = []
258
259 omegaba = []
260 omegadb = []

```

```

261 omegagc = []
262 omegadg = []
263 omegade = []
264 omegaef = []
265
266 alphaba = []
267 alphadb = []
268 alphagc = []
269 alphadg = []
270 alphade = []
271 alphaef = []
272
273 ang_vel_sol_set = []
274 ang_acc_sol_set = []
275 for i in range(len(sol_set)):
276     point_pos = link_point_pos(sol_set[i])
277     point_ax.append(point_pos[0][0])
278     point_ay.append(point_pos[0][1])
279     point_bx.append(point_pos[1][0])
280     point_by.append(point_pos[1][1])
281     point_cx.append(point_pos[2][0])
282     point_cy.append(point_pos[2][1])
283     point_dx.append(point_pos[3][0])
284     point_dy.append(point_pos[3][1])
285     point_ex.append(point_pos[4][0])
286     point_ey.append(point_pos[4][1])
287     point_fx.append(point_pos[5][0])
288     point_fy.append(point_pos[5][1])
289     point_gx.append(point_pos[6][0])
290     point_gy.append(point_pos[6][1])
291     bucket_x.append(point_pos[7][0])
292     bucket_y.append(point_pos[7][1])
293
294     ang_vel_coeff, ang_vel_const = angular_velocity_eqs(sol_set[i][0],
295     ↪ sol_set[i][1], sol_set[i][2], rdotdg, sol_set[i][3], sol_set[i][4],
296     ↪ sol_set[i][5], used_inputs[i])
297     ang_vel_sol_set.append(np.linalg.solve(ang_vel_coeff, ang_vel_const))
298
299     ang_acc_coeff, ang_acc_const = angular_acceleration_eqs(sol_set[i][0],
300     ↪ sol_set[i][1], sol_set[i][2], rdotdg, sol_set[i][3], sol_set[i][4],
301     ↪ sol_set[i][5], used_inputs[i], rddotdg, ang_vel_sol_set[i][1],
302     ↪ ang_vel_sol_set[i][2], ang_vel_sol_set[i][3],
303     ↪ ang_vel_sol_set[i][4], ang_vel_sol_set[i][5])
304     ang_acc_sol_set.append(np.linalg.solve(ang_acc_coeff, ang_acc_const))
305
306
307 ba_ang_vel = [point[0] for point in ang_vel_sol_set]
308 ba_ang_acc = [point[0] for point in ang_acc_sol_set]
309
310 def r_degrs(num):
311     return num/pi*180 % 360
312
313 s = list(s)
314 for i in range(len(s)):
315     if not i in unknown_length_indices:

```

```

310     s[i] = r_degrs(s[i])
311 print(f"Theta_BA = {round(s[0], 3)} degrees")
312 print(f"Theta_DB = {round(s[1], 3)} degrees")
313 print(f"Theta_GC = {round(s[2], 3)} degrees")
314 print(f"Theta_DG = {round(s[3], 3)} degrees")
315 print(f"Theta_DE = {round(s[4], 3)} degrees")
316 print(f"Theta_EF = {round(s[5], 3)} degrees")
317
318 plot_path =
    ↪ os.path.join(os.path.split(os.path.split(os.path.abspath(__file__))[0])[0],
    ↪ "imgs")
319
320 # Link Points Plot
321 plt.rcParams['font.size'] = 12
322 fig1, ax1 = plt.subplots(layout='constrained')
323 ax1.grid()
324 ax1.plot(bucket_x, bucket_y, 'black', label = 'Bucket Coupler Point')
325 ax1.plot(point_ax, point_ay, color='orange', marker='o', label = 'Point A')
326 ax1.plot(point_bx, point_by, 'red', label = 'Point B')
327 ax1.plot(point_cx, point_cy, color='green', marker='o', label = 'Point C')
328 ax1.plot(point_dx, point_dy, 'blue', label = 'Point D')
329 ax1.plot(point_ex, point_ey, 'purple', label = 'Point E')
330 ax1.plot(point_fx, point_fy, color='gray', marker='o', label = 'Point F')
331 ax1.plot(point_gx, point_gy, 'maroon', label = 'Point G')
332 ax1.set_xlim(-20, 80)
333 ax1.set_ylim(-20, 80)
334 ax1.set_aspect('equal', adjustable='box')
335 ax1.set_xlabel('Absolute x-coordinate (inches)')
336 ax1.set_ylabel('Absolute y-coordinate (inches)')
337 ax1.legend(bbox_to_anchor=(1.1, 1), loc='upper left')
338 plt.savefig(os.path.join(plot_path, "LinkPointCoordinates.png"), dpi=400)
339
340
341 plt.rcParams['font.size'] = 12
342 fig1, ax1 = plt.subplots(layout='constrained')
343 ax1.grid()
344 ax1.plot(used_inputs, ba_ang_vel, color='black', linestyle='solid', label =
    ↪ '$\\omega_{ba}$')
345 ax1.set_xlabel('Input length (inches)')
346 ax1.set_ylabel('Angular velocity (rad/s)')
347 ax1.legend(bbox_to_anchor=(1.1, 1), loc='upper left')
348 plt.savefig(os.path.join(plot_path, "LinkBAAngVel.png"), dpi=400)
349
350
351 plt.rcParams['font.size'] = 12
352 fig1, ax1 = plt.subplots(layout='constrained')
353 ax1.grid()
354 ax1.plot(used_inputs, ba_ang_acc, color='black', linestyle='solid', label =
    ↪ '$\\alpha_{ba}$')
355 ax1.set_xlabel('Input length (inches)')
356 ax1.set_ylabel('Angular acceleration (rad/s^2)')
357 ax1.legend(bbox_to_anchor=(1.1, 1), loc='upper left')
358 plt.savefig(os.path.join(plot_path, "LinkBAAngAcc.png"), dpi=400)

```

## Multiloop Solver Output

---

```
PS C:\...\Honors> python code/main.py
Theta_BA = 82.249 degrees
Theta_DB = 335.111 degrees
Theta_GC = 52.91 degrees
Theta_DG = 52.91 degrees
Theta_DE = 67.581 degrees
Theta_EF = 170.215 degrees
```

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